

Dear april hiring team,

Tax season stresses all of us out. Building software that makes it less miserable sounds to me like a cause of pure virtue, and something I could turn my ten years of full-stack experience to. I've built the whole path: React front ends, Python/TypeScript backend APIs, Postgres/Mongo schemas, Terraform/Tofu for infra, Cloudflare for hosting and serving. Your post asks for someone who can own a project end to end and mentor the team along the way. That's what I already do on a smaller scale.

On dyingskies.com I built both halves of a production system. A React 19/TypeScript/Vite front end running a Canvas render loop, and a FastAPI/Postgres backend handling auth and rate limiting, deployed with OpenTofu and GitHub Actions that only touch the services a push changes. On another project, WordLeaves, I built a generic `TreeService<T>` base class inside a layered Node/Express API, so two different node types could share one recursive traversal and deletion path, then wired JWT auth and request validation around it.

I currently lead a small engineering team at Pharmacists Mutual. I own architecture calls, hiring, mentoring, training (both the software and data engineers), and onboarding. I also built the security framework (least-privilege access, managed settings, custom MCP servers) that cleared agentic coding (Claude Code) for developer use. Early in my career I wrote the nightly job running our OFAC compliance screenings, and I've served as the knowledge source for our premium/loss financial calculation for the last 4 years - handling sensitive financial data carefully is not new territory for me.

I like the idea of building something people actually rely on to get their taxes right; I'd be pleased as punch to chat about how I could bring some of that enthusiasm to the april team.

All the best,
Sander VanWilligen